

Scout Fellowship

Surrey Stroll 1986

Despite a couple of minor hiccups the event seemed to be well received, and the Scout Fellowships of the County have decided to organise another 'Stroll' in 1987.

The date will be 10th May 1987, and following some very constructive comments on the 1986 event the following changes will be made in the rules to make the competition more enjoyable, and hopefully attract more entries.

1. The event will be over one day only, and all in daylight
2. The North Downs Way will still provide the route, but the mileage will be reduced to approx. 25.
3. Due to the early start times required to enable the course to be completed in one day, competitors can elect which end of the route they wish to start from.
4. Basic kit requirements will be advised.

I trust that all Scout Fellowship members, and older Venture Scouts will put the 1987 date in their diaries, form teams and take part. Entry forms and full details will be available from your A.D.C. (Scout Fellowship) in February.

Holiday Homes Trust

One of the nicest aspects of being part of a movement such as ours is the unexpected pleasant surprises that keep happening. The latest was a cheque for the Holiday Homes Trust, sent to me for onward transmission by the 1st Walton-on-Thames Beaver Colony, being the

result of a tea party and entertainment for their parents. The donation is most gratefully received, and will further the work of the Trust in providing holidays for the handicapped and their families.

Cash, used stamps, coins, and trading stamps are always needed. Why not have a look in those cupboards and drawers and see what you have got laying around. No use to you perhaps, but they could provide more facilities for those in need. I will be happy to arrange collection and delivery.

Scout Fellowship Competition

This event planned for 13th July was cancelled due to lack of interest by District Fellowships, only four out of eighteen showing willingness to take part. This was particularly disappointing as the event had been planned at the request of the Districts, and would have afforded Fellowship members, and their families the chance to meet, in a relaxed atmosphere members from other areas.

In view of this cancellation the Fred deGraaf Trophy for the top Fellowship of 1985/86 has been awarded to Staines District, for their winning effort in the first Surrey Stroll. Well done!

By the time you read this column, entry forms for the County Swimming Gala, and the County Venture Competition for 1986 should be available in your District. If you still do not know anything about these competitions, ask about.

ERIC MACKIE

County Commissioner

Participation

Open P.O.R. and turn to Rule 1. Perhaps we need Rule 2 as well, but frankly if we were perfect we might throw the rest of the book away. But we are only human and need to have the other 178 rules to get us out of the mess we make of ourselves.

Rule 1 tells us that we must encourage the development of young people, and it tells us how – by providing an enjoyable and attractive scheme of progressive training, in other words it must be fun and it must stretch our young people. It gives us the basis for that training – The Scout Law and Promise and it asks us, the adults, to 'guide' our scouts, and not teach or order them.

But there is a bit that I have overlooked, and I think we all overlook it too often – '... so that they may take a constructive place in society.' Not so that they may have a good time, or so that we can turn out lots more leaders for our movement.

When we see a Queen's Scout receive his or her badge we are reminded quite clearly of this good citizenship, our end product. Indeed when I make such presentations I always make a point of saying that here is someone ready to put talents to the good of God and fellowmen. However, and though we have a record number in Surrey, most of our Cub Scouts and Scouts and Venture Scouts don't become Queens Scouts. So what of them?

Taking a constructive place in society is not as simple as it may sound. It means firstly being 'in society', not opting out. It means respecting other people's views, even when you don't agree with them. It means being prepared to work with other people for purposes that don't simply earn money but help others. It means avoiding accidents, planning ahead, speaking out when you believe things are wrong, keeping your temper, obeying the law over small things as well as big ones, and above all it means getting everyone involved, whatever their age and whatever their talents.

It is never too early to start the training for this process. Cub Scouts should have a Sixers' Council with real business to discuss. The Patrol Leaders' Council

must be made to work, even when you know it would be quicker to do it yourself. The Venture Scout Executive Committee must be allowed to make its own mistakes. But it is more subtle than that. Is the Cub Scout who never really joins in waiting to be asked? Is the Scout who is a nuisance ready to accept more responsibility rather than to be told off? Is the Venture Scout who always fails to help with the simple things in the unit ready to be shocked into action by seeing real hardship at first hand in a developing country?

There used to be an unwritten Scout Law in my day in the troop that, 'A Scout is not a fool', and there is a lot of truth in it. We don't need to spell out to our Cub Scouts that the ambulance men they see when the Cub Pack visits the ambulance station are serving society and that one day they could do the same, or to our Scouts that one day they too will be old and need their gardens dug for them, or to our Venture Scouts that they have a choice between spending their energy as football hooligans in Amsterdam and digging drinking water wells in Sri Lanka. But we do need to provide the opportunities for our young people to discover these things for themselves and that taking a constructive part in society can be fun. If we don't let them make their own decisions in their own movement what price constructive citizenship?

A Warden for Bentley Copse

I am delighted to tell you that Michael and Glenys Lewis have been appointed as Wardens for Bentley Copse and will take up their posts in November. Michael has been an A.D.C. in Coventry and Glenys has held warrants as a Guider and Cub Scouter. In wishing them well, may I thank all those who have held the fort for us over the summer and ensured that the facilities of our County Campsite have been used to the full.

A Thought

Count the number of indoor meetings you had since last September, and the number of outdoor ones and consider whether we can still call ourselves an outdoor movement, if not, do something about it.

DEREK R. POLLARD

Chaplain

If you've run it, you will know that the hardest part of the London Marathon is when you reach Tower Bridge and you've already done half of the course. Then you bear right turn your back on the finish, and head into the Isle of Dogs, London's dockland.

Everything seems to go quiet. The runners don't chat so much now, and your muscles are beginning to complain so much you can hardly hear the crowds. The sun seems hotter, and the rain, if it's raining, wetter; and there's a big question mark forming in your mind – "Will I ever make it?"

In marathon jargon it's called 'Hitting the Wall' and it isn't very nice.

And it happens in life. Scouts mostly have a pretty clear sense of direction. But things can happen, like a bad illness, or a great disappointment, a failure in an examination or a job; the break-up of a friendship, or, often worst of all, the death of a close relative or friend

– and suddenly your sense of direction has gone, and you're asking yourself "Can I cope? ... or Will I make it?"

When that happens, I know of no answer but to remember that, given a chance, Jesus Christ is there on the road at your elbow (no, much closer than that), reminding you that He knows what it's like to feel the pain and loneliness, and the urge to give up. Better still, assuring you that He will stay with you and give His own kind of strength to see you through your Isle of doubt or despair, or fear or frustration, and all the way to the finish – as St Paul put it "... winners, through Him who loves us" Romans 8-28

Post Script

The chaplains would be very grateful for any feedback, advice etc on St George's Day (or other) Services for Beavers.

TOM FARRELL

Rifle Club

All Units should receive a copy of the annual shoot details with this edition of "Surrey Scout". There are still 3 practice dates prior to the competition (October 12th). If Units wish to get in some last minute practice, these dates are September 7th, 21st and 28th. All bookings and enquiries to Ric Melling, 32 Rydeshill Road, Guildford GU2 6SS.

For Sale

Gestetner Electronic Duplicator Model No 260. Automatic with control delivery.

Needs servicing but worked when last used.

Enquiries/offers to SSGMC Secretary Sue Day (01) 764 8550.

Dear Editor

As Public Relations Officer for Runnymede District, I was looking forward to the get together arranged by Michael Beach on 27th May, at the Wilkinson Centre in Dorking. This seemed a marvellous opportunity to meet the other District representatives and find out how they were facing up to the problems, perhaps better or worse but ideas might be gleaned to add to our efforts.

At the meeting, our hosts arranged chairs in a broad semi-circle but this sadly dwindled from an expected twenty down to just eight. Although Michael commented light-heartedly on the not too favourable response, I do think that if the actual P.R.O. was unable

to attend the District ought to have made sure that it was represented.

If we are to make good headway on the P.R. campaign and increase the number of members, we need the support of the County Team and in turn should support their initiatives. I am sure that Surrey will benefit from Michael Beach's enthusiasm and expertise but while he does the steering it's up to the rest of us to do a bit of pedalling! Some of the ideas that may come up from time to time may prove to be 'pies in the sky' but 'nothing ventured, nothing gained'.

VINCE SMITH

Cub Scouts

For all parents of school age children and for all those in any way concerned with education, September often feels like the beginning of a new year. New teachers, new pupils, new schools and perhaps new resolutions to do better than last year.

In Cub scouting we are coming to the end of a special celebration year when many events both nationally, the superb Leaders Camp at Gilwell, and locally, the many Rainbow activities that I have seen, have given us the opportunity to reassess what we are trying to achieve in the section. With 7,000 Cub Scouts and the obvious enthusiasm of so many leaders, we have much of which to be proud. I was very proud at the National Leaders Camp to be part of a County that had produced bases of such good quality and with such cheerfulness. We all have problems on the way to achieving our goals, but a big thank you to everyone who was in any way involved in the display at Gilwell. I hope to persuade everyone to reassemble the bases at the beginning of next year for the benefit of the leaders who could not get to the camp.

As we come to the end of the Rainbow year, could we think about the colour, violet. It represents "people". That is what Scouting is all about. Our aim is the development of the individual boy, but how can we help him unless we too are developing our skills and talents. We are only concerned with part of his development and therefore must involve other people in our aim. Which leads me into the area of "Links". It is 6 months since Beaver Scouts officially became members of our Movement. How much do you know about them? Have you seen them in action? What links does your Cub Pack have with Beavers? Do your Cub Scouts know that Beavers exist? If you can foresee any problems arising within your Group, have you discussed solutions? We have an ideal opportunity to establish good, positive links right from the beginning. At the other end of the section we are still working out our problems after 70 years. In October I have the opportunity to talk to A.D.C.s (S) and A.D.C.s (L.T.) from the South East region for about 20 minutes on the subject of links, and I have chosen as the title "Cub Scouting is Fun, Scouting is a serious business". How do you honestly view the Scout Troop? How do your Cub Scouts view the Scout Troop? The Link Badge is our responsibility. Are we satisfied that it is working to

the benefit of all the boys in our Pack. The seminar in October should stimulate discussion in the Districts. Are you ready for a reappraisal in your Group and do you have suggestions for improvements if they are necessary?

This all involves communication, my second topic for thought this month. Ideal communication is one to one, but because the size of the organisation we all have to rely on the printed word. When people say that they don't know what is going on, I wonder whether they ever get to see "Surrey Scout" or their District newsletters. Have you made sure that all the other leaders in the section have had a chance to read this? And not just the Cub Scout leaders either. There is a message for A.D.C.s (L.T.) coming up soon.

The other method of communication is the County, District or Group meeting. Are you represented? The next County Sub-Committee for the Cub Scout section is on Tuesday 30th September at Leatherhead. This committee is made up of the A.D.C. (Cub Scouts) and one representative from the Cub Scout Section from each District. Do you know who the Cub Scout representative is and do you have anything you wish to raise at the next meeting? If so, make sure that your comments reach your representative before the 30th.

While I am on the topic of communication, it has disturbed me recently to find while talking to new leaders that many of them do not seem to have a District Directory or a list of District contacts. So, A.D.C.s (L.T.), if you read the Cub Scout section, how about a copy of the District Directory for all leaders attending G.I. courses?

Celebrations for our 70th birthday have been going on all year and I have seen and heard of a magnificent selection of birthday cakes at District events (like 'SHARE 86') and at Group parties. The year has not quite finished and I wish you all success with the final stage of these colourful celebrations.

And one final invitation, don't forget to join us at St. Martin's Church, Dorking on September 14th for our Service of Rededication. If you have read the local paper, you will know that the golden cockerel on the top of the Church Spire has just been cleaned. Just for us?

JUDY BANKS

Scouts

Well, September is here again! It does not seem to be one year since we all changed our present section programme. Looking back over that year we (that is you) have done very well indeed. Many troops now have P.L.C.s whereas others who had nominal P.L.C.s have moved on to use them more effectively. Of course, there are troops who are still trying to get an effective P.L.C. off the ground. I think this is all very encouraging and is due entirely to the leaders and the support they have been given by their district teams. Lets keep the good work up so that this time next year all troops have effective P.L.C.s. After all it is the only way the training programme can be operated properly.

One piece of good news is that the long awaited resource material for proficiency badges is now available from the Resource Centre, Gilwell Park entitled

"Proficiency Badge Resource Material for Scouts and their Leaders" No S-S-37-86B, the cost is £11.85 which on the face of it appears to be a little expensive. However it is excellent value as you will see when your troop buys a copy. This material really is a must for all troops so please send for your copy today!

The county finals of the British Meat Scout and Guide Camp Cooking Competition have taken place and was a keenly fought event. The winners were Falcon Patrol from 1st Chiddingfold in Haslemere District. The details of the Patrol have gone forward to Gilwell Park. We now have to wait to see if they are selected to represent the region in the Grand Final. I hope they are selected and wish them good fortune as they would be excellent representatives for the County.

STEVE HALL

"No one ever asks us"

How often is this cry made about the Training Programme, Proficiency badge content, uniform matters, changes to P.O.R., activity Rules and many other things. Your views are welcome and most useful, and part of the essential communication which keeps H.Q. and the Movement in touch with each other.

To help with this communication each Region in England and Wales (we in Kent, Surrey and Sussex are in Region 2) has a representative on each of the six National Advisory Boards. These representatives are available for consultation by Districts and for invitation to meetings of A.D.C.s and Scouters and as speakers at conferences, etc. They are appointed to keep you in touch with Headquarters, and Headquarters with Scouting in Counties and Districts. If you wish to contact your representatives, they are:

Beaver Scout

To be nominated

Cub Scout

Mrs Pam Clifford, 30 Chartway, Reigate RH2 0NZ
Scout

D. Schildkamp, 11 Gables Avenue, Brighton BN1 5FG

Venture Scout

David Popple, "Iona", Bentsbrook Park, North Holmwood, Dorking RH5 4JL

Leader Training

Jim Elliot, 22 Parkway, Eastbourne BN20 9DX

Activities

John Bevan, 4 Woodland Way, Bidborough, Tunbridge Wells TN4 0UX

International

Reporters

Everybody who has been abroad this summer has a tale to tell, and I hope you will share your experiences with your Group/Unit, other Groups/Units, the local press and me (by way of the orange report form).

1987

It is not too early to start your plans for next year's expedition, and one of your first actions should be to apply to me for the 'Camping Abroad' folder.

Australian Jamboree - Christmas 1987

The national contingent is likely to total 760, the maximum number of places available (the capacity of two jumbo jets!) Surrey will be sending 24 and linking with another County, as yet undecided, to form a troop of 36. It is hoped to carry out interviews for Leader places in September, and those who have applied will be advised in due course. Selection of District representative should be made, preferably before the end of 1986, in order that troop preparations can commence.

We have just received from Headquarters, the first invoice and the first payment of £150 per person is due immediately. Further payments are due in mid-November 1986, mid-January 1987 and mid-July 1987. District Treasurers have been notified of details.

New Address

Please note that my new address is 1 Oaklands Way, Tadworth, Surrey KT20 5SW. Tel: Tadworth 3889.

TERRY MAGGS

Air Activities

It is unusual for reference to be made in these pages, to the resignation of a Commissioner of another County. But as far as Air Activities are concerned, the Counties of Surrey and G.L.S.W. have been working together since the 'split' in 1965 and the success of the Air Activity programme is due, in no small part, to the A.C.C. (Air Activities) in G.L.S.W., Alan Foreman. After 14 years service, Alan has found it necessary to hand over the duties to a successor. There are many scouts in Surrey who would wish to thank Alan for all that he has done for Surrey. In paying tribute to Alan, we wish Pete Thompson every success as the new A.C.C. with the wish that the two Counties continue to operate together as before.

Basic Course in Air Training

These courses are held over two Sundays when full tuition and practical skills are provided, followed by a separate opportunity to be tested. Scouts should be at least 13 years old at the beginning of the course and those who reach an acceptable standard will be awarded either the Junior Airman or the Airman badge.

There are still places on the last two basic courses this year: Sept. 14th & 28th, testing Oct. 5th. Nov. 9th & 23rd, testing Nov. 30th.

If you require details of either course, please contact Alan Foreman, 13^W Cascades, Courtwood Lane, Croydon, Surrey CR0 9HY. Tel: (01) 651 2427.

Full details of courses to be held next year will be published later.

Congratulations

CHIEF SCOUT'S AWARD

Scott Boyden	1st Weston Green
Richard Bradshaw	1st St Johns
Anthony Gray	Royal Grammar School, Guildford
Phillip Herring	1st St Johns
Simon Holland	Royal Grammar School, Guildford
Nicholas Jupp	1st Warlingham
Paul Morgan	1st Weston Green
Andrew Muckle	Royal Grammar School, Guildford
Adam O'Brien	Royal Grammar School, Guildford
Jason Pringle	Royal Grammar School, Guildford
Simon Scarboro	1st Tatsfield
Martin Stephen	1st St Johns
Neil Thomson	Royal Grammar School, Guildford
Paul Whitford	7th Horley

Smiths Charity

Applications to the Charity for financial assistance in 1987 should be with the County Grant Aid Adviser, Peter Lankester, by the beginning of November this year (1986). Application forms are available from District Commissioners. It should be remembered that assistance towards the purchase of motor vehicles is excluded and that only capital projects are eligible for assistance. The Grant Aid Adviser will be pleased to advise you in connection with any application.

County Diary

September

- 14 Canoe Regatta
- 18 Water Activities Sub-Committee
- 18 Venture Scout Sub-Committee
- 23 Chaplains Meeting
- 30 Cub Scout Sub-Committee

October

- 5 Sailing Regatta
- 6 Scout Sub-Committee
- 9 Finance Sub-Committee
- 11 Chief Scout Award Presentation
- 12 Venture Scout Rifle Club Annual Shoot
- 14 Scout Fellowship Sub-Committee
- 16 Programme & Training Sub-Committee
- 21 County Executive Committee
- 26 Scout Cooking Competition

November

- 1 Swimming Gala
- 2 Thames Canoe Race Part 2
- 15/16 Venture Competition

December

- 2 Water Activities Sub-Committee
- 4 Venture Scout Sub-Committee

October "Surrey Scout"

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